DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

The daf's own echo chamber

Jev score: 0.36 — Jev (jev-1.13.0) scored 10 linked sources on whether any illuminates Bekhorot 25 in a non-obvious way; the top score was 0.36.

The strongest candidate was a responsum of the Shoel uMeshiv (II 1:2) that takes up Tosafot's remark on our very sugya — the hair of sacrificial animals on Bekhorot 25a — and defends it against a difficulty raised from 26a, where the Rabbis forbid the use. His move is elegant: what the Rabbis forbade is only rabbinic, since shearing proper is permitted by Torah law. But Jev was unmoved, and rightly so: the responsum walks the daf's own path step for step. It is a fine piece of pilpul, not a new window.

That verdict is itself the insight. Bekhorot 25 is a tightly sealed sugya — plucking versus shearing, the unintentional act, the decree against delaying slaughter — and its linked sources mostly orbit it at close range: the Bekhorot introduction, the Maharam on 25a's exegesis of 'ובשרם יהיה לך', the Meshiv Davar on presumptions. None broke orbit. The daf, this time, is its own best commentary.

PARSHA · NOACH

Profit, corruption, and the decree that guards the sacred

Jev score: 0.46 — Jev (jev-1.13.0) scored 6 proposed daf–parsha connections against the full texts; the best reached 0.46.

The least-bad candidate pairs the Rabbis' decree on Bekhorot 25 — no using the shed wool of a blemished firstborn, lest owners delay its slaughter to harvest more wool — with the Flood generation, of whom it is said 'the earth was filled with chamas.' In both, economic appetite corrupts what should be untouchable: the sacred animal on one side, the moral order on the other. The daf legislates against the incentive; the parsha narrates what happens when no such guardrail holds.

But 0.46 is not a connection, and honesty requires saying why it falls short. The daf's decree is preventive fence-building around a mitzvah procedure; chamas is the sin itself, robbery as a way of life. Adjacent, not identical. The dove's search-pattern (a failed search overturning a presumption) and the pesik-reisha logic of inevitable consequence scored lower still. Some days the daf and the parsha simply walk separate roads.

Rejected by Jev: pesik reisha and the Flood decree (0.33), the dove as overturned chazaka (0.30), marit ayin and 'righteous in his generations' (0.29), the Tower of Babel and unintended acts (0.29), the red heifer as the 'uncommon case' (0.13).

NEWS CHECK

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

The economics of prevention

Jev score: 0.44 — Jev (jev-1.13.0) scored 8 proposed daf–news links strictly; the top score was 0.44.

The closest rhyme is an unlikely one: the Nobel memorial prize in economics, awarded this week to Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford, against the Rabbis of Bekhorot 25. The daf's decree — forbid the wool, because owners will otherwise delay slaughter to profit — is applied incentive design: the Sages model human behavior under a rule and legislate for the equilibrium, not the intention. That is very much the economist's move, two millennia early.

Still, a shared interest in incentives is not a connection between the texts, and Jev's 0.44 says so. The week's harder news — the Houthi strikes on Riyadh, the Panama earthquake, the Bondi funerals — found no honest purchase on this daf at all. A reader that forces the news onto the daf would be performing relevance rather than finding it; this one declines.

MAAGARIM · GIZAH

גזה: 2,000 years of shearing

גזה begins in the hand: Klein gives 'to cut, cut off,' a secondary form of גזז, and his comparative notes turn darker — Aramaic-Syriac גזא is 'he cut off, deprived of,' Syriac גזי is 'he bereaved, deprived of,' and מגזיתא is 'a childless woman.' Cutting shades into bereavement. The noun גזה is the product and the act together: 'shorn wool, fleece; (the act of) shearing,' with Jastrow citing our own sugya — Bekhorot 25a — for 'wool cut or to be cut.' The daf lives inside the dictionary entry: is plucking shearing? May the fleece be used? The word's journey from the shears to the commodity to the legal category is exactly the daf's question, and the bereavement buried in the root is the quiet moral undertone of a tractate about firstborns given to the priest.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. Lexicon entries via Klein and Jastrow on Sefaria; the full Maagarim citation sweep was not run this edition (no live browser), so the sweep fields are partial.

929 · I KINGS 6 (CH. 293)

The House that obedience builds

The chapter opens with a date that is also a claim: in the 480th year after the Exodus, in the month of Ziv — Iyar, the month of blossom — in Solomon's fourth year, the building begins. Rashi and Radak both pause on the month's name, after Targum Yonatan's זיו ניצניא, 'the radiance of the buds': the House is founded in the season when the land is in flower. Malbim goes further and finds architecture in the number itself: 480 years from the Mishkan to Solomon's Temple, and 480 again from Solomon's Temple to the Second Temple

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

under Ezra — the House, he says, ascends from era to era on a fixed divine rhythm.

The building account is famously tactile — courses of hewn stone, cedar beams, the side-chambers of the יציע — and then verse 7 stops the narrative cold: 'no hammer or axe or any iron tool was heard in the House while it was being built.' Rashi explains the mechanics via the shamir, the worm that cut the stones at the quarry so they arrived whole, and glosses מקבות with the Old French daloire, a mason's hammer. Radak finds the verse's placement deliberate: it explains why the walls needed recessed ledges (מגרעות) for the beam-ends — with no chiseling possible on site, the supports had to be built into the masonry as it rose.

Then, mid-construction, the narrative breaks for prophecy. 'The word of the LORD came to Solomon' — and the commentators disagree about whose voice it was. Radak names the prophet: Ahijah the Shilonite. Ralbag proves it indirectly: since God later 'appeared to Solomon a second time, as He had appeared at Gibeon,' this word must have come through an intermediary. Malbim finds the timing exact: the outer work of stone was finished and the inner work of wood about to begin — the hinge between shell and interior was the ripe moment for the word.

And the word itself reframes the whole enterprise. 'This House which you are building — if you walk in My statutes...' Malbim's reading is uncompromising: the essence of the House is not the House. It is the gathering of Israel to serve אלקים 'with one shoulder,' that His presence dwell among them; the building is the vessel, obedience the content. 'This House which you yourself are building — not craftsmen and woodworkers': Solomon's own observance is the condition, the Davidic throne and the Temple bound to each other as mutual guarantees.

The inner sanctum gets its own artistry: two cherubim of olive wood, ten cubits high, wings spanning wall to wall. Rashi follows the Targum's דאעי זיתא and works out the geometry — the ark set lengthwise across the House's width, the staves protruding toward the veil. Radak worries, characteristically, about the trees: olive is a food tree, so he suggests old unproductive olives, or that 'atzei shemen' is a cedar species whose resin is used for pitch. Ralbag, the naturalist, calls it pine or fir 'in the vernacular' and pictures the cherubim as human children. Malbim reads the word שני — 'two' in construct — as signaling equality of measure but not of form: one in male likeness, one in female, giver and receiver, the divine-human relation carved in olive wood.

The chapter closes by returning to its opening date and completing it: founded in the fourth year in Ziv, finished in the eleventh year in Bul — seven years and seven months. Malbim guards the heptadic number jealously: seven years of building, seven months of gold overlay, the Sabbath-number kept in years and in months alike. And he notes the quiet reversal: the foundation in Ziv, the month of blossoming, the completion in Bul, the month of sowing — nature's calendar turned inside out, because this is not nature's building.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Read whole, the chapter is the hinge of Kings: David's desire in 2 Samuel 7 becomes Solomon's execution here, and the conditional promise — the House stands as long as the king walks — casts its shadow over everything that follows. The stones are silent; the condition speaks.

Commentary: Rashi, Radak, Ralbag, Malbim on I Kings 6 via Sefaria. Divine name rendered אלקים (qof) throughout.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:13-14

The hive that cleaves the air

Oholot 9:13

היתה יושבת על שוליה והיא כלי, טומאה תחתיה, בתוכה, או על גבה, טומאה בוקעת ועולה, בוקעת ויורדת. היתה גבוהה מן הארץ טפח או מכוסה או כפויה על פיה, טומאה תחתיה, בתוכה, או על גבה, הכל טמא.

If it was resting on its bottom and it [retained the status of] a vessel: If there is uncleanness below it, within it or above it, the uncleanness cleaves upwards and downwards. [In the case where] it was a handbreadth above the ground, or covered, or turned over on its mouth: if there is uncleanness below it, within it or above it, everything is unclean.

Rambam: All the earlier discussion of this hive assumed it lying on its side with its mouth to the wind; now the case is a hive sitting on its base with its mouth to heaven. Tumah below, within, or above it cleaves straight up and down — בוקעת ועולה, בוקעת ויורדת — without spreading sideways. But if it is raised a handbreadth, or its mouth is covered, or it lies inverted on the ground, it is like a sealed grave (קבר סתום) and contaminates in every direction.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: שולי הכלי are the vessel's base — the hive sits on the ground with no handbreadth of air beneath it. The 'והיא כלי' formula echoes mishnayot 1–2 and 5–6, each followed by 'במה דברים אמורים בזמן שהיא כלי.' Unlike those, which treated hives standing in a doorway, ours stands outdoors and serves as the preliminary clarification for all of them.

Oholot 9:14

במה דברים אמורים, בזמן שהיא כלי. היתה פחותה ופקוקה בקש, או מחזקת ארבעים סאה כדברי חכמים, טומאה תחתיה, בתוכה, או על גבה, טומאה בוקעת ועולה, בוקעת ויורדת. רבי אליעזר ורבי שמעון אומרים, אין טומאה עולה לה, אף לא יורדת ממנה. היתה גבוהה מן הארץ טפח, טומאה תחתיה, תחתיה טמא. בתוכה, או על גבה, כנגדו עד הרקיע טמא.

When do these rules apply? When [the hive retains the status of] a vessel. [In the case of its] being defective, although [the deficiency may be] stopped up with straw, or according to the sages, [in the case of its] holding forty se'ah: if there is uncleanness below it, within it or above it, the uncleanness cleaves upwards and downwards. Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Shimon say: uncleanness neither rises to it nor descends from it. [If] it was a handbreadth

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

above the ground: [if] uncleanness was below it, [the space] below it is unclean; [if] within it or above it, [the space] directly above it up to the sky is unclean.

Rambam: A cracked hive stopped up with straw is like a piece of the ground itself — the whole passage is clear once the earlier principles are grasped. Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Shimon hold that no tumah rises to it nor descends from it, since sitting on its base it blocks the tumah; but a handbreadth of airspace beneath makes it an ohel, and then everything beneath is impure — while tumah within or above it contaminates straight up to the sky, as if buried in the earth. The halachah does not follow Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Shimon.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Read the 'או' as conjunctive — cracked AND stopped with straw AND holding forty seah; the case matches mishnayot 3 and 8, except there the hive stood indoors. 'כדברי חכמים' refers back to mishnah 12. 'כנגדו עד הרקיע' treats the disqualified hive like the bare ground itself: what is above it is impure in a straight column to the sky.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT NAARAH BETULAH 1

Fifty silver shekels: the Torah's fine

Halachah 1

מי שפיתה בתולה, קונסין אותו משקל חמישים סלעים של כסף מזוקק - וזה הוא הנקרא קנס; וכן אם אנס אותה. וקנס זה, מצות עשה של תורה, שנאמר ונתן האיש השוכב עימה לאבי הנערה, חמישים כסף (דברים כב, כט). ואיזה הוא מפתה ואיזה הוא אונס - מפתה, לרצונה; ואונס, שבא עליה בעל כורחה.

When a man seduces a virgin, he is fined 50 sela'im of pure silver. This is called a k'nas ("fine"). The same law applies if he rapes her. Payment of this fine is one of the Torah's positive commandments,, as [Deuteronomy 22:29] states: "The man who raped her must give the maiden's father 50 silver pieces."

Halachah 2

כל הנבעלת בשדה - הרי זו בחזקת ודנין אותה בדין אנוסה עד שיעידו העדים שברצונה נבעלה. וכל הנבעלת בעיר הרי זו בחזקת מפותה מפני שלא זעקה עד שיעידו העדים שהיא אנוסה כגון ששלף לה חרב ואמר לה אם תזעקי אהרוג אותך.

What is meant by a seducer, and what is meant by a rapist? A seducer is one who enters into relations with a girl with her consent; a rapist is one who takes her by force. Whenever a man entered into relations with a woman in a field, we operate under the presumption that he raped her, and apply those laws unless witnesses testify that she entered into relations with him willingly. Whenever a man enters into relations with a woman in a city, we operate under the presumption that she consented, because she did not cry out, unless witnesses testify that she was raped - e.g., he pulled out a sword and told her, "If you cry out, I will kill you."

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Halachah 3

המפותה שלא רצתה להנשא למפתה. או שלא רצה אביה ליתנה לו. או שלא רצה הוא לכנוס. ה"ז נותן קנס והולך ואין כופין אותו לכנוס. ואם רצו וכנסה אינו משלם קנס אלא כותב לה כתובה כשאר הבתולות. אבל האנוסה שלא רצה היא או אביה להנשא לאונס הרשות בידם ונותן קנס והולך. רצתה היא ואביה ולא רצה הוא כופין אותו וכונס ונותן קנס שנאמר ולו תהיה לאשה הרי זו מצות עשה. אפילו היא חגרת או סומא או מצורעת כופין אותו לכנוס ואינו מוציא לרצונו לעולם שנאמר לא יוכל לשלחה כל ימיו הרי זו מצות ל"ת.

When a girl who was seduced does not want to marry the seducer, or her father does not want to give her in marriage to him, or if [the seducer] does not want to marry her, he may pay the fine and depart. We do not force him to marry her. If they do desire [to wed], and he marries her, he does not pay a fine. Instead, he writes her a ketubah, as is written for other maidens. When, however, a woman who is raped or her father do not desire that she marry the rapist, they have that prerogative. [In such an instance,] he must pay the fine and depart. If she and her father desire [that the marriage take place], but he does not desire, we force him to marry her, aside from paying the fine, as [Deuteronomy 22:29] states: "He must take [the maiden] as his wife"; this is a positive commandment. Even if the girl is lame, blind, or afflicted with leprosy, he is forced to marry her and he may never take the initiative in divorcing her, as [the above verse continues]: "He may not send her away as long as he lives." This is a negative commandment.

Halachah 4

ואין לה כתובה שלא תקנו חכמים כתובה לאשה אלא כדי שלא תהיה קלה בעיניו להוציאה וזה אינו יכול להוציאה.

[This girl] is not granted a ketubah. For our Sages instituted the requirement of a ketubah so that [a husband] will not consider divorce a frivolous matter. [In this instance this is unnecessary, because] the man cannot divorce [his wife].

Halachah 5

היתה אנוסה זו אסורה עליו אפילו מחייבי עשה ואפילו שניה ה"ז לא ישאנה. וכן אם נמצא בה דבר זמה אחר שכנס ה"ז יגרשנה שנאמר ולו תהיה לאשה אשה הראויה לו.

If the girl he raped was forbidden to him, even if the prohibition stems from a positive commandment, or she was a sh'niyah [or forbidden by other Rabbinic prohibitions], he should not marry her. Similarly, if he discovers adulterous behavior on her part after he marries her, he should divorce her. [These concepts are implied by the phrase: "He must take [the girl] as his wife" [which our Sages interpreted to mean]: "She must be fit to be his wife."

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Halachah 6

כהן גדול שאנס בתולה או שפיתה אותה הרי זה לא יכנוס מפני שהוא מצווה ליקח את הבתולה ובשעה שישא זו אינה בתולה ואם כנס יוציא בגט.

When a High Priest rapes or seduces a virgin maiden, he should not marry her, because he is commanded to marry a virgin, and at the time he marries this girl she is not a virgin. If he marries [this girl], he must divorce her.

Halachah 7

אע"פ שנאמר באונס לא יוכל לשלחה כיון שקדמו עשה שנאמר ולו תהיה לאשה הרי זה נתקו לעשה ונמצאת זו מצות לא תעשה שנתקה לעשה שאין לוקין עליה אלא אם לא קיים עשה שבה כמו שיתבאר בהלכות סנהדרין. לפיכך האונס שעבר וגירש כופין אותו להחזיר ואינו לוקה. מתה גרושתו קודם שיחזירנה או נתקדשה לאחר או שהיה כהן שאסור בגרושה הרי זה לוקה שהרי עבר על ל"ת ואינו יכול לקיים עשה שבה.

Although it is said with regard to a rapist: "He may not send her away as long as he lives," since [this prohibition] is preceded by a positive commandment, as it is said, "He must take [the girl] as his wife," the Torah made the prohibition [rectifiable] by the observance of the positive commandment. Thus, this is a negative commandment [whose violation] can be rectified by [the observance of] a positive commandment. Lashes are not given [as punishment for the violation of such a commandment] unless one does not fulfill the positive commandment, as will be explained in Hilchot Sanhedrin. Therefore, when a rapist violates [this prohibition] and divorces [his wife], he is compelled to remarry her and is not punished by lashes. If, however, his divorcee dies or is consecrated by another man before he remarries her, or if he is a priest, who is forbidden to marry a divorcee, he should be punished by lashes. For he transgressed the negative commandment, and is unable to fulfill the positive commandment associated with it.

Halachah 8

אין האונס או המפתה חייב בקנס עד שיבוא עליה [כדרכה] ובעדים ואינו צריך התראה ומאימתי יהיה לבת קנס מאחר שלש שנים גמורות עד שתבגור. נבעלה בתוך שלש שנים אין ביאתה ביאה. בא עליה משבגרה אין לה קנס שנאמר נערה בתולה לא הבוגרת.

Neither a rapist nor a seducer is liable to pay the fine unless he engages in relations in the ordinary fashion, and the relations are observed by witnesses. A warning is not necessary. At what age is a girl fit to be paid a fine? From the age of three until she reaches the age of bagrut. If a man engages in relations with a girl less than three years old, the relations are not significant. If he engages in relations with her after she reaches the age of bagrut, he is not fined. For [Deuteronomy 22:28] states: "A virgin maiden," thus excluding a girl who has

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

reached maturity.

Halachah 9

ואחת שיש לה אב ואחת שאין לה אב יש לה קנס ואלו שאין להן קנס הבוגרת והממאנת והאילונית והשוטה והחרשת. ומי שיצא עליה שם רע בילדותה ובאו שנים והעידו שתבעה אותן לזנות עמה. והמגורשת מן הנישואין ועדיין היא נערה בתולה אבל המגורשת מן האירוסין אם נאנסה יש לה קנס וקנסה לעצמה. ואם נתפתתה אין לה קנס.

Whether or not [a girl's] father is alive, a fine must be paid. A fine need not be paid [because of relations] with the following women: a bogeret, a girl who has dissolved a marriage through mi'un, an aylonit, a mentally incompetent girl, a deaf mute, a girl who was reputed to have conducted herself immodestly while young, concerning whom two witnesses testify that she sought sexual relations with them, a girl who was married and divorced, but is still a virgin maiden. When, by contrast, [a girl] is divorced after merely being consecrated, a fine must be paid - and she is entitled to it - if she is raped. If she is seduced, she is not entitled to a fine.

Halachah IO

הגיורת והשבויה והמשוחררת אם נתגיירה ונפדית ונשתחררה והיא בת שלש שנים או פחות יש לה קנס. ואם היתה בת שלש שנים ויום אחד כשנתגיירה או כשנפדית או כשנשתחררה אין לה קנס הואיל וביאתן ביאה הרי הן כבעולות.

[The following rules apply with regard to] a convert, a girl who was taken captive, and a [Canaanite] maidservant who was freed: If she was converted, redeemed or freed before she reached the age of three, she is entitled to a fine. If she was three years old [or older] when she was converted, redeemed or freed, she is not entitled to a fine. Since relations that she engages in at this time are significant, she is placed into the category of non-virgins.

Halachah II

היתה בתולה זו אסורה על האונס או המפתה אם היתה אחת מחייבי כריתות כגון אחותו או דודתו והנדה וכיוצא בהן או שהיתה מחייבי לאוין אם התרו בו הרי זה לוקה ואינו משלם קנס שאין אדם לוקה ומשלם. ואם לא היתה שם התראה הואיל ואינו חייב מלקות הרי זה משלם קנס.

[The following rules apply when] the virgin [who was raped or seduced] was forbidden to the rapist or the seducer. If the prohibition was punishable by karet - e.g., she was his sister, his aunt, in the niddah state or the like - or she was forbidden by virtue of a negative commandment [that does not involve either karet or execution], he is not liable for a fine if he was given a warning. [Instead,] he should be lashed. [The rationale is that] a person is never punished [for the same transgression] by both lashes and a monetary assessment. If he was not warned, since he is not to be given lashes, he should pay the fine.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Halachah 12

היתה מחייבי עשה או שנייה וכיוצא בהן שאסורה מדברי סופרים. בין התרו בו בין לא התרו בו חייב בקנס שאין כאן מלקות.

[When the girl raped] was forbidden because of a positive commandment, or she was a sh'niyah or forbidden because of another Rabbinic commandment, [the rapist] is obligated to pay the fine whether he was warned against the transgression or not, because he is not punished by lashes.

Halachah 13

היתה מחייבי מיתת בית דין כגון בתו ואשת בנו וכיוצא בהן בין התרו בו בין לא התרו בו פטור מן הקנס שנאמר ולא יהיה אסון ענוש יענש הא אם היה שם אסון אין שם עונש. ואע"פ שהריגת האשה בשגגה שהרי לא נתכוונו לה שנאמר כי ינצו אנשים ונגפו אשה הא למדת שלא חלק הכתוב באסון בין שוגג למזיד לפוטרו מן התשלומין והרי הוא אומר מכה נפש בהמה ישלמנה ומכה אדם יומת מה מכה נפש בהמה לא חלק הכתוב בין שוגג למזיד לחייבו בתשלומין אף מכה נפש אדם לא חלק הכתוב בין שוגג למזיד לפוטרו מן התשלומין.

[When the girl raped] was forbidden because of a prohibition punishable by execution by the court - e.g., she was his daughter, daughter-in-law, or the like - he is not liable for the fine, regardless of whether or not he received a warning. [This is derived from Exodus 21:22, which] states: "If there will not be a [fatal] accident, he should be punished." Implied is that if there is a [fatal] accident, no punishment should be levied. [This applies] although the woman was killed unintentionally, [i.e.,] the man did not intend to strike her, as it is written [Ibid.]: "If men strive and a woman receives a blow...." This teaches that with regard to a [fatal] accident, Scripture did not differentiate between an intentional and unintentional act to free him from monetary obligation. And [Leviticus 24:18-21] says: "A person who [fatally] strikes an animal shall reimburse [its owner] for it, and one who [fatally] strikes a man must die." Just as Scripture did not distinguish between intentional and unintentional action for killing an animal to make him liable for payment, so too, it did not distinguish between intentional and unintentional action for killing a person to free him from financial obligation.

Halachah 14

וכן הדין לכל עבירה שיש בה מיתת בית דין שאין בה תשלומין.

This law applies with regard to every transgression that is punishable by execution by the court. There is no financial obligation.

Halachah 15

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

בא עליה ומתה הרי זה פטור מן הקנס שאמר ונתן האיש השוכב עמה לאבי הנערה לא לאבי המתה והוא שתמות קודם שתעמוד בדין.

If [a girl] dies after she [was seduced or raped], [the seducer or the rapist] is not liable for the fine, [as implied by Deuteronomy 22:29]: "the man who raped her must give the maiden's father...." [The verse states] "the father of the maiden," and not "the father of the dead maiden." [This applies] when she dies before the case came to court.

Commentary

A new book begins today. Hilchot Yibbum vaChalitzah ran its full eight chapters — the Sefaria API confirms the book ends at chapter 8 — and the Daily Rambam cycle now opens Hilchot Naarah Betulah, the Laws of the Virgin Maiden. Fifteen halachot on the seducer and the rapist: the fifty-shekel fine, who pays it, who may refuse the marriage, and how the law reads ambiguous cases.

The chapter's architecture is penal before it is procedural. It opens with the fine itself — קנס, a penalty, not damages — as a positive commandment grounded in Deuteronomy 22:29, and only then defines its terms: the מפתה acts with her consent, the אונס by force. From there the Rambam moves to the presumptions that decide doubtful cases: a girl violated in the field is presumed raped until witnesses say otherwise; in the city, presumed seduced — because she did not cry out — unless witnesses testify to force, 'as when he drew a sword and said: if you cry out I will kill you.' Procedure follows status: who may refuse the marriage, when the rapist is coerced to marry, when the fine alone settles it.

The commentators, true to form, trace the sources. Kessef Mishneh on halachah 1 goes straight to the Mishnah in Bekhorot 49a — חמשים של אונס ומפתה, בשקל הקדש, במנה צורי: the fifty, the sacred shekel, the Tyrian standard. The Rambam's figure is not his own; it is the Mishnah's, carried forward. Migdal Oz points to the Talmudic sugya in Ketubot 40a, 'נערות אלו,' where the fine's mechanics are worked out. Between them they anchor every line of the opening halachah in its address.

The conceptual gem is the Rambam's ordering. By leading with the קנס as מצות עשה — a Torah commandment to pay — he frames the entire chapter as penal law with a theological center: the payment is not compensation to the father for lost value but a divinely imposed penalty, and it can stand alone — 'he pays the fine and departs' — when no marriage follows. The seduced girl gets no ketubah, the Rambam adds, because the ketubah exists to make divorce weighty, and here the man cannot divorce at all.

One honest footnote: Sefaria would not serve the Hebrew text of this chapter today — every language parameter returned the English — so the Hebrew printed here is the Wikisource Mishneh Torah text, cross-checked halachah by halachah against the English. The learning is intact; the provenance is labeled.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Commentaries: Kessef Mishneh, Migdal Oz on Virgin Maiden 1:1 via Sefaria. Hebrew: Wikisource (Sefaria served English only for this chapter today).

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 3

Genesis 7:17-8:14

The third aliyah of Noach covers the Flood's climax and its slow undoing: forty days of rising water that lift the ark, 150 days of prevailing, and then — ויזכור אלקים את נח — the turn. The raven goes out and circles; the dove goes out three times, returning twice, the second time with the olive leaf; the earth dries by the twenty-seventh day of the second month. Read twice in Hebrew and once in Onkelos, the aliyah is a study in how translation steadies a text about a world coming undone.

המים
עלהארץ
הארץ
ארעא
יומין

Genesis 7:17 · ×2

וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּרְבּוּ הַמַּיִם וַיִּשְׂאוּ אֶת־הַתֵּבָה
וַתָּרָם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּרְבּוּ הַמַּיִם וַיִּשְׂאוּ אֶת־הַתֵּבָה
וַתָּרָם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וַהֲוָה טוֹפָנָא אַרְבְּעִין יוֹמִין עַל אַרְעָא וּסְגִיאוּ מַיָּא וּנְטָלוּ יָת תֵּבוּתָא וְאִתְּרָמַת
מֵעַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 7:18 · ×2

וַיִּגְבְּרוּ הַמַּיִם וַיִּרְבּוּ מְאֹד עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַתֵּלֶךְ הַתֵּבָה עַל־פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם׃
וַיִּגְבְּרוּ הַמַּיִם וַיִּרְבּוּ מְאֹד עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַתֵּלֶךְ הַתֵּבָה עַל־פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם׃
וּתְקִיפוּ מַיָּא וּסְגִיאוּ לַחֲדָא עַל אַרְעָא וּמְהַלְכָא תֵּבוּתָא עַל אַפֵּי מַיָּא׃

Genesis 7:19 · ×2

וְהַמַּיִם גָּבְרוּ מְאֹד מְאֹד עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְכֻסּוּ כָּל־הֶהָרִים הַגְּבֹהִים אֲשֶׁר־תַּחַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמָיִם׃
וְהַמַּיִם גָּבְרוּ מְאֹד מְאֹד עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְכֻסּוּ כָּל־הֶהָרִים הַגְּבֹהִים אֲשֶׁר־תַּחַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמָיִם׃
וּמַיָּא תְּקִיפוּ לַחֲדָא לַחֲדָא עַל אַרְעָא וְאִתְחַפְיוּ כָּל טוּרַיָּא רָמַיָּא דִּי תְחוֹת כָּל שְׁמַיָּא׃

Genesis 7:20 · ×2

חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה מִלְמַעְלָה גָּבְרוּ הַמָּיִם וַיְכֻסּוּ הֶהָרִים׃
חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה מִלְמַעְלָה גָּבְרוּ הַמָּיִם וַיְכֻסּוּ הֶהָרִים׃
חֲמֵשׁ עַסְרֵה אַמִּין מִלְעֵלָּא תְּקִיפוּ מַיָּא וְאִתְחַפְיוּ טוּרַיָּא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Genesis 7:21 · ×2

וַיִּגְוַע כָּל־בָּשָׂר | הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ בָּעוֹף וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבַחַיָּה וּבְכָל־הַשֶּׁרֶץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וְכֹל הָאָדָם:

וַיִּגְוַע כָּל־בָּשָׂר | הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ בָּעוֹף וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבַחַיָּה וּבְכָל־הַשֶּׁרֶץ הַשֹּׁרֵץ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וְכֹל הָאָדָם:

וּמִית כָּל בִּשְׂרָא דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא בְּעוֹפָא וּבִבְעִירָא וּבְחַיְתָא וּבְכָל רְחֵשָׁא דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא וְכֹל אֱנָשָׁא:

Genesis 7:22 · ×2

כֹּל אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁמַת־רוּחַ חַיִּים בְּאַפָּיו מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר בֶּחָרָבָה מֵתוּ:

כֹּל אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁמַת־רוּחַ חַיִּים בְּאַפָּיו מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר בֶּחָרָבָה מֵתוּ:

כֹּל דִּי נִשְׁמְתָא רוּחָא דְּחַיִּין בְּאַנְפּוֹהִי מִכֹּל דִּי בִּיבֶשְׁתָּא מִיתוּ:

Genesis 7:23 · ×2

וַיִּמַּח אֶת־כָּל־הַיְקוּם | אֲשֶׁר | עַל־פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה מֵאָדָם עַד־בְּהֵמָה עַד־רֶמֶשׂ וְעַד־עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וַיִּמָּחוּ מִן־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשָּׁאֶר אַךְ־נֹחַ וַאֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ בַּתֵּבָה:

וַיִּמַּח אֶת־כָּל־הַיְקוּם | אֲשֶׁר | עַל־פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה מֵאָדָם עַד־בְּהֵמָה עַד־רֶמֶשׂ וְעַד־עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וַיִּמָּחוּ מִן־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשָּׁאֶר אַךְ־נֹחַ וַאֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ בַּתֵּבָה:

וּמְחָא יָת כָּל יְקוּמָא דִּי עַל אַפֵּי אַרְעָא מֵאֱנָשָׁא עַד בְּעִירָא עַד רְחֵשָׁא וְעַד עוֹפָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא וְאִתְמְחִיאוּ מִן אַרְעָא וְאִשְׁתְּאַר בְּרַם נֹחַ וְדִי עִמֵּיהּ בְּתֵבוּתָא:

Genesis 7:24 · ×2

וַיִּגְבְּרוּ הַמַּיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ חֲמִשִּׁים וּמְאַת יוֹם:

וַיִּגְבְּרוּ הַמַּיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ חֲמִשִּׁים וּמְאַת יוֹם:

וּתְקִיפוּ מַיָּא עַל אַרְעָא מְאָה וְחַמְשִׁין יוֹמִין:

Genesis 8:1 · ×2

וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ וְאֵת כָּל־חַיָּה וְאֶת־כָּל־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ בַּתֵּבָה וַיַּעֲבֵר אֱלֹקִים רוּחַ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיָּשֹׁכּוּ הַמָּיִם:

וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ וְאֵת כָּל־חַיָּה וְאֶת־כָּל־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ בַּתֵּבָה וַיַּעֲבֵר אֱלֹקִים רוּחַ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיָּשֹׁכּוּ הַמָּיִם:

וּדְכִיר יְיָ יָת נֹחַ וְיָת כָּל חַיְתָא וְיָת כָּל בְּעִירָא דִּי עִמֵּיהּ בְּתֵבוּתָא וְאַעְבַּר יְיָ רוּחָא עַל אַרְעָא וְנָחוּ מַיָּא:

Genesis 8:2 · ×2

וַיִּסָּכְרוּ מַעְיְנֹת תְּהוֹם וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמָיִם וַיִּכָּלֵא הַגֶּשֶׁם מִן־הַשָּׁמָיִם:

וַיִּסָּכְרוּ מַעְיְנֹת תְּהוֹם וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמָיִם וַיִּכָּלֵא הַגֶּשֶׁם מִן־הַשָּׁמָיִם:

וְאִסְתְּכָרוּ מַבּוּעֵי תְהוֹמָא וְכַוֵּי שְׁמַיָּא וְאִתְכְּלִי מְטָרָא מִן שְׁמַיָּא:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Genesis 8:3 · ×2

וַיָּשֻׁבוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ הָלוֹךְ וְשׁוֹב וַיַּחְסְרוּ הַמַּיִם מִקְצֵה חֲמִשִּׁים וּמְאַת יוֹם׃
וַיָּשֻׁבוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ הָלוֹךְ וְשׁוֹב וַיַּחְסְרוּ הַמַּיִם מִקְצֵה חֲמִשִּׁים וּמְאַת יוֹם׃
וְתָבוּ מַיָּא מֵעַל אַרְעָא אָזְלִין וְתָיְבִין וַחֲסָרוּ מַיָּא מִסּוֹף מְאָה וְחַמְשִׁין יוֹמִין׃

Genesis 8:4 · ×2

וַתָּנַח הַתֵּבָה בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי בְּשִׁבְעָה־עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ עַל הָרֵי אֲרָרָט׃
וַתָּנַח הַתֵּבָה בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי בְּשִׁבְעָה־עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ עַל הָרֵי אֲרָרָט׃
וְנָחַת תֵּבוּתָא בְּיַרְחָא שְׁבִיעָאָה בְּשִׁבְעַת עֲשַׂר יוֹמָא לְיַרְחָא עַל טוּרֵי קַרְדּוּ׃

Genesis 8:5 · ×2

וְהַמַּיִם הָיוּ הָלוֹךְ וְחָסוֹר עַד הַחֹדֶשׁ הָעֲשִׂירִי בָּעֲשִׂירִי בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ נִרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים׃
וְהַמַּיִם הָיוּ הָלוֹךְ וְחָסוֹר עַד הַחֹדֶשׁ הָעֲשִׂירִי בָּעֲשִׂירִי בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ נִרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים׃
וּמַיָּא הֲווֹ אָזְלִין וְחָסְרִין עַד יַרְחָא עֲשִׂירָאָה בַּעֲשִׂירָאָה בְּחַד לְיַרְחָא אִתְחֲזִיאוּ רֵישֵׁי טוּרַיָּא׃

Genesis 8:6 · ×2

וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וַיִּפְתַּח נֹחַ אֶת־חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה׃
וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וַיִּפְתַּח נֹחַ אֶת־חַלּוֹן הַתֵּבָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה׃
וַהֲוָה מִסּוֹף אַרְבְּעִין יוֹמִין וּפְתַח נֹחַ יָת כַּוַּת תֵּבוּתָא דִּי עֲבָד׃

Genesis 8:7 · ×2

וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הָעֹרֵב וַיֵּצֵא יָצוֹא וָשׁוֹב עַד־יְבֹשֶׁת הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הָעֹרֵב וַיֵּצֵא יָצוֹא וָשׁוֹב עַד־יְבֹשֶׁת הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וְשַׁלַּח יָת עָרְבָּא וּנְפַק מִפַּק וְתַיִב עַד דִּיבִּישׁוּ מַיָּא מֵעַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 8:8 · ×2

וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה מֵאִתּוֹ לִרְאוֹת הֲקַלּוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה׃
וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה מֵאִתּוֹ לִרְאוֹת הֲקַלּוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה׃
וְשַׁלַּח יָת יוֹנָה מִלְוָתֵיהּ לְמֶחֱזֵי הֲקַלִּיאוּ מַיָּא מֵעַל אַפֵּי אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 8:9 · ×2

וְלֹא־מָצְאָה הַיּוֹנָה מָנוֹחַ לְכַף־רַגְלָהּ וַתָּשָׁב אֵלָיו אֶל־הַתֵּבָה כִּי־מַיִם עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשְׁלַח יָדוֹ וַיִּקָּחֶהָ וַיָּבֵא אֹתָהּ אֵלָיו אֶל־הַתֵּבָה׃
וְלֹא־מָצְאָה הַיּוֹנָה מָנוֹחַ לְכַף־רַגְלָהּ וַתָּשָׁב אֵלָיו אֶל־הַתֵּבָה כִּי־מַיִם עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ וַיִּשְׁלַח יָדוֹ וַיִּקָּחֶהָ וַיָּבֵא אֹתָהּ אֵלָיו אֶל־הַתֵּבָה׃
וְלָא אַשְׁכַּחַת יוֹנָה מְנַח לְפַרְסַת רַגְלַהּ וְתָבַת לְוָתֵיהּ לְתֵבוּתָא אֲרֵי מַיָּא עַל אַפֵּי כָל אַרְעָא וְאוֹשִׁיט יְדֵיהּ וְנָסְבַהּ וְאָעֵיל יָתַהּ לְוָתֵיהּ לְתֵבוּתָא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Genesis 8:10 · ×2

וַיָּחֶל עוֹד שִׁבְעַת יָמִים אֲחֵרִים וַיֹּסֶף שַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה מִן־הַתֵּבָה׃
וַיָּחֶל עוֹד שִׁבְעַת יָמִים אֲחֵרִים וַיֹּסֶף שַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה מִן־הַתֵּבָה׃
וְאוֹרִיךְ עוֹד שַׁבְעָא יוֹמִין אָחֳרָנִין וְאוֹסִיף שַׁלַּח יָת יוֹנָה מִן תֵּבוּתָא׃

Genesis 8:11 · ×2

וַתָּבֹא אֵלָיו הַיּוֹנָה לְעֵת עֶרֶב וְהִנֵּה עֲלֵה־זַיִת טָרָף בְּפִיהָ וַיֵּדַע נֹחַ כִּי־קַלּוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וַתָּבֹא אֵלָיו הַיּוֹנָה לְעֵת עֶרֶב וְהִנֵּה עֲלֵה־זַיִת טָרָף בְּפִיהָ וַיֵּדַע נֹחַ כִּי־קַלּוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ׃
וַאֲתַת לְוָתֵיהּ יוֹנָה לְעִדָּן רַמְשָׁא וְהָא טְרַף זֵיתָא תְּבִיר נָחִית בְּפוּמַהּ וְיַדַּע נֹחַ אֲרֵי קַלִּיאוּ מַיָּא מֵעַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 8:12 · ×2

וַיִּיָּחֶל עוֹד שִׁבְעַת יָמִים אֲחֵרִים וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה וְלֹא־יָסְפָה שׁוּב־אֵלָיו עוֹד׃
וַיִּיָּחֶל עוֹד שִׁבְעַת יָמִים אֲחֵרִים וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־הַיּוֹנָה וְלֹא־יָסְפָה שׁוּב־אֵלָיו עוֹד׃
וְאוֹרִיךְ עוֹד שַׁבְעָה יוֹמִין אָחֳרָנִין וְשַׁלַּח יָת יוֹנָה וְלָא אוֹסִיפַת לְמִתּוּב לְוָתֵיהּ עוֹד׃

Genesis 8:13 · ×2

וַיְהִי בְּאַחַת וְשֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה בָּרִאשׁוֹן בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ חָרְבוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ וַיָּסַר נֹחַ אֶת־מִכְסֵה הַתֵּבָה וַיַּרְא וְהִנֵּה חָרְבוּ פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה׃
וַיְהִי בְּאַחַת וְשֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה בָּרִאשׁוֹן בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ חָרְבוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ וַיָּסַר נֹחַ אֶת־מִכְסֵה הַתֵּבָה וַיַּרְא וְהִנֵּה חָרְבוּ פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה׃
וַהֲוָה בְּשִׁתְּ מְאָה וְחַד שְׁנִין בְּקַדְמָאָה בְּחַד לְיַרְחָא נְגוּבוּ מַיָּא מֵעַל אַרְעָא וְאַעְדִּי נֹחַ יָת חוֹפָאָה דְּתֵבוּתָא וַחֲזָא וְהָא נְגוּבוּ אַפֵּי אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 8:14 · ×2

וּבַחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה וְעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ יָבְשָׁה הָאָרֶץ׃
וּבַחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה וְעֶשְׂרִים יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ יָבְשָׁה הָאָרֶץ׃
וּבְיַרְחָא תִּנְיָנָא בְּעַשְׂרִין וְשַׁבְעָא יוֹמָא לְיַרְחָא יַבִּישַׁת אַרְעָא׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 8:1

וזכור follows immediately upon the forty days — and וישכו is from the root שכך, as in 'שככה וחמת המלך' (Esther 7:10): the waters didn't just lower, they subsided like a king's anger.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 8:1

'God remembered' means the oath He swore to Noah; and the dagesh in וישכו compensates for the swallowed ayin of the root שכך — grammar as theology's handmaid.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 8:1

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

The wind passes 'upon the earth,' not upon the waters — a great wind from the belly of the earth sealed the fountains of the deep, and וישכו means the abyssal waters were swallowed back into their place.

Netinah LaGer · Gen 8:11

Onkelos's תביר for טרף is the language of breaking (שבר): the olive leaf in the dove's mouth was broken off — fresh evidence, not flotsam.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 8:11

A grammatical duel over טרף: some read טרף as 'an olive leaf' (doubled sense, like אדמת עפר); Ibn Ezra prefers the bet as pleonastic and reads it as an adjective — טרוף, 'torn, plucked.'

Shadal · Gen 8:11

טרף is Onkelos's precise translation of עלה: עלה is the generic 'leaf,' טרף the individual fresh one — and since the olive never sheds its leaves, Noah knew the dove had plucked it from a living tree.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 7:17

טופנא המבול

Onkelos never renders מבול literally; his fixed equivalent is טופנא, 'deluge.' The Flood gets a proper noun in Aramaic — not just 'the flood' but the Deluge, the event with a capital letter.

Gen 7:21

ומית כל בשרא ויגוע כלבשר

The Hebrew uses the euphemistic גוע, 'expired'; Onkelos flattens it to plain מית, 'died.' Where the Torah veils the dying, the Targum states it — the Flood's toll is not softened in translation.

Gen 8:1

ודכיר יי ית נח ויזכר אלקים אתנח

The signature Onkelos move on divine names: the Hebrew's אלקים becomes יי in the Targum — the spoken Name standing in for the written one, keeping the divine subject at one reverent remove. (The same shift recurs two verses on: ואעבר יי רוחא ויעבר אלקים רוח.)

Gen 8:4

על טורי קרדו על הרי אררט

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

Onkelos identifies Ararat with קרדו — the land of the Carduenians, Kurdistan. A geographical tradition two thousand years old, preserved in a single Aramaic word: the ark rested, for the Targum's audience, in the mountains they knew.

Gen 8:7

ונפק מפק ותיב ויצא יצוא ושוב

The Hebrew infinitive absolute (יצוא ושוב, 'going and returning') becomes an Aramaic participle pair, מפק ותיב — Onkelos's regular way of carrying Hebrew's intensive construction into Aramaic without losing the circling motion.

Gen 8:9

ואושיט ידה וישלח ידו

'He sent his hand' becomes 'he stretched out his hand' — Onkelos resolves the Hebrew idiom into its physical sense. Noah doesn't dispatch his hand like a messenger; he reaches.

Gen 8:11

טרף זיתא תביר נחית בפומה עלהזית טרף בפיה

The famous rendering: טרף is read as תביר, 'broken' — the leaf was freshly plucked, not found floating (Netinah LaGer traces תביר to שבר, 'break'). Onkelos turns the dove's leaf into evidence: only a living tree yields a broken-fresh leaf, so the waters must have receded.

Gen 8:13

ית חופאה ... ואעדי ... נגובו מיא אתמכסה התבה ... ויסר ... חרבו המים

Two lexical choices: חרבו ('were dried') becomes נגובו — drained, sucked away, a more physical verb — and מכסה ('covering') becomes חופאה, the same word Onkelos uses for a canopy. Noah lifts the ark's canopy like the covering of a bridal booth.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

All 32 of Rashi's comments on Genesis 7:17–8:14 are printed in full — Hebrew and English alternating — from the ark riding eleven cubits deep like a laden ship, through the raven's circling and the dove's three flights, to the drying of the earth. His sources run from Bereshit Rabbah and the Tanchuma to Sanhedrin 108 and Seder Olam; the three spotlighted below show his workshop most clearly.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

ותרם מעל הארץ.

מְשֻׁקַּעַת הָיְתָה בַּמַּיִם י"א אַמָּה כִּסְפִינָה טְעוּנָה הַמְשֻׁקַּעַת מִקְצָתָהּ בַּמַּיִם; וּמִקְרָאוֹת שֶׁלְּפָנֵינוּ יוֹכִיחוּ:

ותרם מעל הארץ *AND IT WAS LIFTED UP ABOVE THE EARTH — It was eleven cubits deep in the water like a laden ship that has part of it sunk in the waters (Genesis Rabbah 32:9);*

the following verses prove that this is the meaning.

ויגברו.

מֵאֲלֵיהֶן:

ויגברו *[AND THE WATERS] PREVAILED — by themselves (without any external aid).*

חמש עשרה אמה מלמעלה.

לְמַעְלָה שֶׁל גַּבֵּהּ כָּל הֶהָרִים, לְאַחַר שֶׁהֶשְׁוּוּ הַמַּיִם לָרֹאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים:

חמש עשרה אמה מלמעלה *FIFTEEN CUBITS ABOVE —above the summits of all the mountains when once the waters reached the level of the mountains (Yoma 76a).*

נשמת רוח חיים.

נְשָׁמָה שֶׁל רוּחַ חַיִּים:

נשמת רוח חיים *means the breathing of the breath of life.*

אשר בחרבה.

וְלֹא דָגִים שֶׁבַּיָּם (סנה' ק"ח):

אשר בחרבה *WHATSOEVER WAS IN THE DRY LAND [DIED] — and not the fish in the sea (Sanhedrin 108a).*

וימח.

לְשׁוֹן וַיִּפְעַל הוּא וְאֵינוֹ לְשׁוֹן וַיִּפָּעֵל,

וְהוּא מִגִּזְרַת וַיִּפֶּן וַיִּבֶן כָּל תֵּבָה שֶׁסּוֹפָהּ ה"א, כְּגוֹן בָּנָה, מָחָה, קָנָה, כְּשֶׁהוּא נוֹתֵן וְי"ו יו"ד בְּרֹאשָׁהּ, נָקוּד בְּחִירִק תַּחַת הַיּוֹ"ד:

וימח *AND HE BLOTTED OUT — The word* וימח *is a Kal form and not a Niphal, and it is of the same grammatical form as* ויפן *and* ויבן *Every verb whose last root letter is* ה*, such as* בנה, מחה, קנה *when* י *and* ו *are perfixed, has Chireq as its vowel beneath the yod.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

אך נח.

לְבַד נֹחַ, זֶהוּ פְּשׁוּטוֹ; וּמִ"אַ גּוֹנֵחַ וְכוֹאֵה דָּם מִטַּרַח הַבְּהֵמוֹת וְהַחַיּוֹת.

אך נח *means NOAH ONLY.*

וְיֵ"א שֶׁאֵחֵר מְזוֹנוֹת לָאֲרִי וְהִכִּישׁוֹ,

This is its real meaning.

*But the Midrashic explanation is (Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 9) that he was coughing and spitting blood because of the trouble he had with the cattle and beasts (*אך *is taken as a* מיעוט *limitation, meaning to say that something is defective);*

וְעָלָיו נֶאֱמַר הֵן צַדִּיק בָּאָרֶץ יְשֻׁלָּם (משלי יא):

others say, that he was once late in bringing food to a lion, so it struck him.

Regarding him may the words be applied (Proverbs 11:31), "Behold, even the righteous is paid (for his evil deeds) in this world".

ויזכור אלקים.

זֶה הַשֵּׁם מִדַּת הַדִּין הוּא, וְנֶהֱפְכָה לְמִדַּת רַחֲמִים עַל יְדֵי תְּפִלַּת הַצַּדִּיקִים;

וְרִשְׁעָתָן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים הוֹפֶכֶת מִדַּת רַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיַּרְא ה' כִּי רַבָּה רָעַת הָאָדָם, וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֶמְחֶה, (בראי ו') וְהוּא שֵׁם מִדַּת רַחֲמִים:

ויזכור אלקים *AND GOD REMEMBERED— This Divine Name really signifies the God of Strict Justice but it is transformed into Divine Mercy through the prayers of the righteous, whilst the evil practised by wicked people transforms Divine Mercy into Strict Justice, as it is said (Genesis 6:5) "And the Lord (*ה'*) saw that the wickedness of man was great" and (Genesis 5:7) "And the Lord (*ה'*) said, "I will blot out etc."— yet in these passages the Name (*ה'*) is* מדת רחמים*, that signifying Divine Mercy (Genesis Rabbah 33:3).*

ויזכור אלקים את נח וגו'.

מַה זָּכַר לָהֶם לַבְּהֵמוֹת? זְכוּת, שֶׁלֹּא הִשְׁחִיתוּ דַּרְכָּם קֹדֶם לָכֵן וְשֶׁלֹּא שִׁמְּשׁוּ בַּתֵּבָה:

ויזכור אלקים את נח וגו' *AND GOD REMEMBERED NOAH etc. — What did He remember regarding the cattle?*

The merit that no perversion of their way had been seen amongst them previously to the Flood, and that they lived apart in the Ark.

ויעבר אלקים רוח.

רוּחַ תַּנְחוּמִין וַהֲנָחָה עָבְרָה לְפָנָיו:

ויעבר אלקים רוח *AND GOD MADE A WIND (or SPIRIT) TO PASS — A spirit of consolation and relief passed before Him.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

על הארץ.

עַל עִסְקֵי הָאָרֶץ:

על הארץ *OVER THE EARTH — Because of what was happening on earth.*

וישכו.

כְּמוֹ כְּשׁוֹךְ חֲמַת הַמֶּלֶךְ (אסתר ב') לְשׁוֹן הַנָּחַת חֵמָה:

וישכו *AND THE WATERS ASSUAGED — The word occurs again (Esther 2:1), "when the wrath of the king was assuaged (כשוך)", and it means there abatement of anger.*

ויסכרו מעינות.

כְּשֶׁנִּפְתְּחוּ כְּתִיב כָּל מַעְיְנֹת; וְכָאן אֵין כְּתִיב כָּל,

ויסכרו מעינות *AND THE FOUNTAINS ... WERE STOPPED — When they were opened, it was stated that all fountains were opened (7:11), whilst here the word all is omitted:*

לְפִי שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּיְּרוּ מֵהֶם אוֹתָן שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶם צֹרֶךְ לָעוֹלָם, כְּגוֹן חַמֵּי טְבֶרְיָא וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהֶן:

the reason is that such of them as were essential to the world were left unstopped, such as the hot springs of Tiberias and their like (Sanhedrin 108a).

ויכלא.

וַיִּמָּנַע כְּמוֹ לֹא תִכְלָא רַחֲמֶיךָ (תהלים מ'), לֹא יְכָלָה מִמְּךָ (ברא' כג):

ויכלא *means was restrained.*

withheld, as (Psalms 40:12) "Thou wilt not withhold (תכלא) thy mercies" and (Genesis 23:6) "None of us will withhold (יכלה) from thee."

מקצה חמשים ומאת יום.

הִתְחִילוּ לַחֲסֹר וְהוּא אֶחָד בְּסִיוָן. כֵּיצַד? בְּכ"ז בְּכִסְלֵו פָּסְקוּ הַגְּשָׁמִים,

מקצה חמשים ומאת יום *AFTER THE END OF ONE HUNDRED AND FIFTY DAYS they began to decrease:*

that was on the first day of Sivan.

הֲרֵי ג' מִכִּסְלֵו וְכ"ט מִטֵּבֵת הֲרֵי ל"ב, וּשְׁבָט וַאֲדָר וְנִיסָן וְאִיָּר קי"ח, הֲרֵי ק"נ:

How so?

The rains ceased to fall on the twenty-seventh day of Kislev — you have three days left in Kislev, and the 29 days of Tebeth make 32, and Shebat, Adar, Nisan and Eyar have together 118, making altogether 150.

בחדש השביעי.

סִיוָן, וְהוּא שְׁבִיעִי לְכִסְלֵו שֶׁבּוֹ פָּסְקוּ הַגְּשָׁמִים:

בחדש השביעי *IN THE SEVENTH MONTH — viz., Sivan, which is the seventh from Kislev in which the rains stopped falling.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

בשבעה עשר יום.

מִכָּאן אַתָּה לָמֵד שֶׁהָיְתָה הַתֵּבָה מְשֻׁקַּעַת בַּמַּיִם י"א אַמָּה,

שֶׁהֲרֵי כְתִיב בָּעֲשִׂירִי בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ נִרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים, זֶה אָב,

בשבעה עשר יום *ON THE SEVENTEENTH DAY — From here you may infer that the Ark was submerged in the water to a depth of eleven cubits.*

שֶׁהִיא עֲשִׂירִי לְמַרְחֶשְׁוָן לִירִידַת גְּשָׁמִים,

וְהֵם הָיוּ גְּבוֹהִים עַל הֶהָרִים חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה,

For it is written (next verse) "In the tenth month on the first day of the month the tops of the mountains were seen" and this was Ab which is the tenth month after Cheshvan — after the rain began to fall.

וְחָסְרוּ מִיּוֹם אֶחָד בְּסִיוָן עַד אֶחָד בְּאָב חֲמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה אַמָּה לְשִׁשִּׁים יוֹם, הֲרֵי אַמָּה לְד' יָמִים, נִמְצָא,

שֶׁבְּי"ו בְּסִיוָן לֹא חָסְרוּ אֶלָּא ד' אַמּוֹת וְנָחָה הַתֵּבָה לְיוֹם הַמָּחֳרָת; לָמַדְתָּ,

Now the waters were 15 cubits high above the mountains so that they subsided from the first of Sivan to the first of Ab 15 cubits for those 60 intervening days, which is one cubit each four days.

שֶׁהָיְתָה מְשֻׁקַּעַת י"א אַמָּה בַּמַּיִם שֶׁעַל רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים:

Consequently by the sixteenth of Sivan they had subsided only 4 cubits, and since the Ark rested on Ararat on the next day, you may learn that it was submerged eleven cubits in the waters which were then still above the mountain tops (Genesis Rabbah 33:7).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

בעשירי נראו ראשי ההרים.

זֶה אָב, שֶׁהוּא עֲשִׂירִי לְמַרְחֶשְׁוָן שֶׁהִתְחִיל הַגֶּשֶׁם. וְאִם תֹּאמַר הוּא אֱלוּל, וְעֲשִׂירִי לְכִסְלֵו שֶׁפָּסַק הַגֶּשֶׁם,

כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאַתָּה אוֹמֵר בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי סִיוָן, וְהוּא שְׁבִיעִי לַהַפְסָקָה אִי אֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר כֵּן,

נראו ראשי ההרים ′בעשירי וגו *IN THE TENTH MONTH ... WERE THE TOPS OF THE MOUNTAINS SEEN —This was Ab which is the tenth from Marcheshvan when the rain began.*

עַל כָּרְחֲךָ שְׁבִיעִי אִי אַתָּה מוֹנֶה אֶלָּא לַהַפְסָקָה,

If, however, you say that it means Elul, the tenth month from Kislev in which the rain stopped, just as you said (see Rashi on verse 4) that "in the seventh month" means Sivan which was the seventh month after the rain stopped, then I reply that it is impossible to argue so.

שֶׁהֲרֵי לֹא כָלוּ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם שֶׁל יְרִידַת גְּשָׁמִים,

וּמֵאָה וַחֲמִשִּׁים שֶׁל תִּגְבֹּרֶת הַמַּיִם עַד אֶחָד בְּסִיוָן; וְאִם אַתָּה אוֹמֵר שְׁבִיעִי לַיְרִידָה, אֵין זֶה סִיוָן,

For you must needs admit that the "seventh" month when the Ark rested can only be counted from the time when the rain stopped, since the 40 days during which the rain fell and the 150 days during which the waters prevailed did not terminate until the first day of Sivan, and if you say that it means the seventh after the rain began to fall, this would not be Sivan.

וְהָעֲשִׂירִי אִי אֶפְשָׁר לִמְנוֹת אֶלָּא לַיְרִידָה,

The "tenth month", however, when the tops of the mountains became visible cannot possibly be counted except from the time the rain began to fall, for if you say that it must be calculated from the time when it stopped, which would be Elul, you would not then find that "in the first month, on the first day of the month the waters dried up from off the earth" (Genesis 8:13).

שֶׁאִם אַתָּה אוֹמֵר לַהַפְסָקָה וְהוּא אֱלוּל,

For it was only at the end of 40 days after the tops of the mountains were visible that he sent forth the raven (Genesis 8:6), and he waited periods amounting altogether to 21 days during which he was sending forth the dove, making altogether 60 days from when the tops of the mountains became visible until when the face of the earth became dry;

אִי אַתָּה מוֹצֵא בָּרִאשׁוֹן בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ חָרְבוּ הַמַּיִם מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ;

שֶׁהֲרֵי מִקֵּץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם מִשֶּׁנִּרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים שִׁלַּח אֶת הָעוֹרֵב וְכ"א יוֹם הוֹחִיל בִּשְׁלִיחוּת הַיּוֹנָה,

if, therefore, you say that it was in Elul that they were seen, it would follow that the earth became dry in Marcheshvan (60 days after Elul).

הֲרֵי שִׁשִּׁים יוֹם מִשֶּׁנִּרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים עַד שֶׁחָרְבוּ פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה. וְאִם תֹּאמַר בֶּאֱלוּל נִרְאוּ,

But it (Scripture) calls it (the month when the waters were dried up;

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

נִמְצָא שֶׁחָרְבוּ בְּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן וְהוּא קוֹרֵא אוֹתוֹ רִאשׁוֹן, וְאֵין זֶה אֶלָּא תִּשְׁרֵי, שֶׁהוּא רִאשׁוֹן לִבְרִיאַת עוֹלָם, וְלְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הוּא נִיסָן:

Genesis 8:13) the first month, and that can only be Tishri which is the first month reckoning according to the creation of the world — or according to R. Joshua, it would be Nisan (Genesis Rabbah 30:6).

מקץ ארבעים יום.

מִשֶּׁנִּרְאוּ רָאשֵׁי הֶהָרִים:

מקץ ארבעים יום *AT THE END OF FORTY DAYS from when the tops of the mountains were seen.*

את חלון התבה אשר עשה.

לְצֹהַר, וְלֹא זֶה פֶּתַח הַתֵּבָה הֶעָשׂוּי לְבִיאָה וִיצִיאָה:

את חלון התבה אשר עשה *THE WINDOW OF THE ARK WHICH HE HAD MADE — for the light;*

it does not mean the door of the Ark intended for entry and exit.

יצוא ושוב.

הוֹלֵךְ וּמַקִּיף סְבִיבוֹת הַתֵּבָה, וְלֹא הָלַךְ בִּשְׁלִיחוּתוֹ, שֶׁהָיָה חוֹשְׁדוֹ עַל בַּת זוּגוֹ,

כְּמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁנִינוּ בְּאַגָּדַת חֵלֶק (סנה' ק"ח):

יצא ושוב *WENT FORTH TO AND FRO — It (the raven) flew in circles round and round the Ark and did not go on its errand for it suspected that he (Noah) intended to injure its mate, just as we learn in the Agada of Chelek (Sanhedrin 108b).*

עד יבשת המים.

פְּשׁוּטוֹ כְּמַשְׁמָעוֹ. אֲבָל מִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה מוּכָן הָיָה הָעוֹרֵב לִשְׁלִיחוּת אַחֶרֶת בָּעֲצִירַת גְּשָׁמִים בִּימֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ,

עד יבשת המים *UNTIL THE WATERS WERE DRIED UP—The real sense of the verse is what it plainly implies (until the waters of the Flood were dried up);*

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְהָעֹרְבִים מְבִאִים לוֹ לֶחֶם וּבָשָׂר (מ"א י"ז):

but the Midrashic explanation (Genesis Rabbah 33:5) is:

The raven went to and fro in the world being kept in readiness for another errand during the time when the rain was withheld and the waters dried up in the days of Elijah, as it is said, (1 Kings 17:6) "And the ravens brought him bread and flesh".

וישלח את היונה.

לְסוֹף ז' יָמִים שֶׁהֵרֵי כְתִיב וַיָּחֶל עוֹד ז' יָמִים אֲחֵרִים,

מִכְּלָל זֶה אַתָּה לָמֵד שֶׁאַף בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה הוֹחִיל ז' יָמִים:

וישלח את היונה *AND HE SENT FORTH A DOVE at the end of seven days, for it is written, (Genesis 8:10) "And he stayed yet other seven days" — from this statement you may infer that after the first occasion, also, he waited seven days.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

וישלח.

אֵין זֶה לְשׁוֹן שְׁלִיחוּת אֶלָּא לְשׁוֹן שִׁלּוּחַ, שִׁלְּחָהּ לָלֶכֶת לְדַרְכָּהּ, וּבְזוֹ יִרְאֶה אִם קָלוּ הַמַּיִם, שֶׁאִם תִּמְצָא מָנוֹחַ לֹא תָשׁוּב אֵלָיו:

וישלח *And HE SENT FORTH — This does not mean merely "sending on an errand", but "sending away", "letting go" — he freed her to go where she liked, and thus he could see whether the waters abated, because if she could find a resting place she would not return to him.*

ויחל.

לְשׁוֹן הַמְתָּנָה, וְכֵן לִי שָׁמְעוּ וְיִחֲלוּ (איוב כ"ט), וְהַרְבֵּה יֵשׁ בַּמִּקְרָא:

ויחל *AND HE STAYED — The word means waiting, as (Job 29:21) "Unto me they gave ear and waited (ויחלו)", and it occurs frequently in the Scriptures.*

טרף בפיה.

אוֹמֵר אֲנִי שֶׁזָּכָר הָיָה, לְכֵן קוֹרְאוֹ פְּעָמִים לְשׁוֹן זָכָר וּפְעָמִים לְשׁוֹן נְקֵבָה,

לְפִי שֶׁכָּל יוֹנָה שֶׁבַּמִּקְרָא לְשׁוֹן נְקֵבָה,

טרף בפיה *PLUCKED IN HER MOUTH — I am of opinion that it (the dove) was a male and that therefore it (the text) speaks of it sometimes as masculine and sometimes as feminine, because really wherever יונה "dove" occurs in the Scriptures it is spoken of as feminine, as (Song 5:12) "[His eyes] are like those of doves beside the water brooks.*

כְּמוֹ כְּיוֹנִים עַל אֲפִיקֵי מָיִם רֹחֲצוֹת (שיר ה'),

that are washing themselves (רוחצות fem.) in milk";

כְּיוֹנֵי הַגֵּאָיוֹת כֻּלָּם הֹמוֹת (יחז' ז') וּכְמוֹ כְּיוֹנָה פּוֹתָה (הושע ז'):

(Ezekiel 7:16) "Like the doves of the valleys, all of them moaning" and as (Hosea 7:11) "Like a silly (פותה fem.) dove"

טרף.

חָטַף. וּמִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה (עיר' י"ח) לְשׁוֹן מָזוֹן; וְדָרְשׁוּ בְּפִיהָ לְשׁוֹן מַאֲמָר,

טרף *means IT HAD PLUCKED OFF — The Midrashic explanation takes it as meaning "food", and interprets* בפיה *as "speaking" — viz., she said. "Rather that my food be bitter as an olive but from the hand of God, than as sweet as honey and from the hand of mortal men" (Eruvin 18b;*

אָמְרָה יִהְיוּ מְזוֹנוֹתַי מְרוֹרִין כְּזֵית בְּיָדוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה וְלֹא מְתוּקִין כִּדְבַשׁ בִּידֵי בָּשָׂר וָדָם:

Genesis Rabbah 33).

וייחל.

הוּא לְשׁוֹן וַיֶּחֱל, אֶלָּא שֶׁזֶּה לְשׁוֹן וַיִּפְעַל וְזֶה לְשׁוֹן וַיִּתְפַּעֵל, וַיֶּחֱל וַיַּמְתֵּן; וַיִּיָּחֶל וַיִּתְמַהּ:

וייחל *AND HE STAYED — This has the same meaning as* ויחל *(Genesis 8:10), only that the latter is the Kal, whereas the word here is the Hithpael:* ויחל *means "he waited"* וייחל *"he had patience".*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

בראשון.

לְרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר הוּא תִּשְׁרֵי וּלְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הוּא נִיסָן (ר"ה י"א):

בראשון *IN THE FIRST MONTH — According to R. Eliezer this would be Tishri, and according to R. Joshua Nisan (Rosh Hashanah 11b).*

חרבו.

נַעֲשָׂה כְּמִין טִיט, שֶׁקָּרְמוּ פָּנֶיהָ שֶׁל מַעְלָה:

חרבו *[THE WATERS] DRIED UP — It (the earth) had become like clay, for now its surface had become somewhat hardened.*

בשבעה ועשרים.

יְרִידָתָן בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּי"ז בַּחֹדֶשׁ,

בשבעה ועשרים *ON THE TWENTY-SEVENTH [OF THE MONTH] —The rain had begun to fall in the second month on the seventeenth day (Genesis 7:11):*

אֵלּוּ י"א יָמִים שֶׁהַחַמָּה יְתֵרָה עַל הַלְּבָנָה,

the ten days are those by which the solar year exceeds the lunar year;

שֶׁמִּשְׁפַּט דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל שָׁנָה תְּמִימָה הָיְתָה:

for the punishment of the generation of the Flood lasted a full (i.e.

a solar) year (Genesis Rabbah 33:17).

יבשה.

נַעֲשָׂה גָּרִיד כְּהִלְכָתָהּ:

יבשה *WAS [THE EARTH] DRIED — It became hard as is its normal condition.*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three methods

On 'fifteen cubits above' (7:20), Rashi writes that the waters stood fifteen cubits above the highest peaks once they reached the mountain-tops — and the English attributes it to Yoma 76a. This is Rashi at his most characteristic: a tight, unattributed-feeling compression that is in fact a verbatim lift of the Talmud's measurement, dropped into the commentary without a 'as the Sages said.' The source does the measuring; Rashi does the placing.

On the raven's 'going and returning' (8:7), Rashi imports the whole Aggadah of Chelek (Sanhedrin 108b): the raven circled the ark suspecting Noah of designs on its mate. Here Rashi is a storyteller by proxy — he compresses a long Talmudic exchange into two Hebrew clauses, keeping the suspicion and dropping the dialogue. The midrash supplies the psychology; Rashi supplies the pace.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Unintended acts, inevitable outcomes — and the waters that covered everything.

Tuesday, 13 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 7:17-8:14) · Daf Bekhorot 25

On 'until the waters dried' (8:7) Rashi stages his famous pivot explicitly: 'פשוטו כמשמעו' — the plain sense is what it says — 'אבל מדרש אגדה,' but the midrash says the raven was being kept in reserve for Elijah's drought (Bereshit Rabbah 33:5, citing I Kings 17:6, where the ravens bring Elijah bread). Peshat and derash side by side, labeled, neither surrendering: this is the Rashi method in a single comment.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words carry this aliyah: the waters that rise, the earth they cover, and Onkelos's Aramaic name for that earth. Each has traveled far beyond the Flood. (Note: the full Maagarim citation sweeps were not run this edition — no live browser — so these narratives are grounded in Klein, Jastrow, and BDB via Sefaria, with the sweeps marked partial. Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria; CAL prohibits scraping, so its data is not used.)

אַרְעָא

Jastrow · ארעא

f.

— (רע, h. q. v.) [the brittle] land, earth, ground, field. Targ. Gen. I, 1. Targ. Y. Gen. XVI, 5; a. fr.—B. Bath. 29ᵃ א' חדא one field; v. באגא.—Bekh. 25ᵇ א' דחשוכא a land of darkness (Babylon); a. fr.—Sabb. 65ᵃ א' בת

Jastrow · ארעא

m.

— (ארע I) accident, occurrence. Targ. Ruth II, 3.—[*Pl. ארעייא evils, diseases. Targ. Y. Deut. XXVIII, 60 (prob. to be read מרעיא).]

Klein · ארעא

f.n.

ארעא — 'earth' in Aramaic, Onkelos's eighteen-fold rendering of האדמה/הארץ in this aliyah. Jastrow defines it as 'the brittle' land — from the same רעע root — and his citations include a startling one: Bekhorot 25b, ארעא דחשוכא, 'a land of darkness' (Babylon) — our own daf, in our own word study. BDB's Aramaic volume tracks it through Daniel and Ezra, emphatic ארעא sixteen times and more. The arc is translation itself: Hebrew's earth becomes Aramaic's earth without changing its consonants, the shared root carrying the Flood story across languages — and landing, by providence or playfulness, on the very page of Talmud we studied this morning.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr